179 **‘many beggars in these countries which go naked’:** Ralph Fitch, *The First Englishmen in India*, edited by J. Courtenay Locke, London: Routledge, 2004, p. 55.

179 **‘For a long time, His Majesty’s desire was to found a great city’:** Fazl quoted in Surendranath Sinha, *Subah of Allahabad Under the Great Mughals, 1580–1707*, Allahabad: Jamia Millia Islamia, 1974, p. 85.

179 **‘Here is great store of fish of sundry sorts’:** John Pinkerton, *A General Collection of the Best and Most Interesting Voyages and Travels in Various Parts of Asia*, Vol. 3, London: Longman, Hurst, Rees, Orme, and Brown, Paternoster Row, and Cadell and Davies, 1819, p. 411.

180 **‘into the midst of the raging stream 3000 fully equipped horsemen’:** Badauni, *Muntakhabh al-Tawarikh*, Vol. 2, p. 182.

180 **‘the noise, the smoke and the concussion shook the earth’:** Beveridge (trans.), *Akbarnama*, Vol. 3, p. 135.

180 **Daud Khan was believed to have possessed an enormous army of 40,000 cavalry:** Chandra, *A History of Medieval India*, p. 232.

181 **fifty-two bazaars, fifty-two wholesale markets and fifty-two caravanserais:** Tapan Raychaudhari and Irfan Habib (eds.), *The Cambridge Economic History of India*, Vol. 1, p. 325.

182 **‘I received his Majesty’s instructions’:** Badauni, *Muntakhabh al-Tawarikh*, Vol. 2, p. 186.

182 **‘seances for dancing and sufism took place’:** Ibid.

182 **‘done the work of many years’:** Beveridge (trans.), *Akbarnama*, Vol. 3, p. 157.

184 **‘an unrivalled device for organizing the ruling class’:** For detailed explanations see Khan, *India’s Polity in the Age of Akbar*; M. Athar Ali, ‘Towards an Interpretation of the Mughal Empire’, *The State in India, 1000–1700*, edited by H. Kulke, Delhi: Oxford University Press, 1980, pp. 263–77.

184 **‘These men were specialists’:** Stephen P. Blake, ‘Courtly Culture under Babur and the Early Mughals’, *Journal of Asian History*, Vol. 20, No. 2, 1986, pp. 193–214.

184 **men holding ranks upto 500 were all called mansabdars:** Chandra, *Medieval India: Delhi Sultanat, 1206-1526*, Part 1, p. 157; *From Sultanat to the Mughals*, Part 2, p. 157.

184 **Amirs did as they pleased…[putting] most of their own servants:** Michael Fisher, *A Short History of the Mughal Empire*, New Delhi: Bloomsbury Publishing, 2015, p. 104.

185 **‘making loyalty more profitable than rebellion’:** Rima Hooja, *A History of Rajasthan*, p. 447.

185 **‘who was fully conversant with’:** Ibid., p. 536.

186 **‘various villages were endowed to Brahmans, Charans, and Bhats’:** Ibid., p. 544.

186 **‘his saddle is his throne’:** Ibid., p. 546.

186 **‘ivory, copper, dates, gum-arabic, borax, coconuts, silk, chintzes, muslin, shawls’:** Ibid., p. 543.

186 **‘with all its post-life connotations of hell-fire and damnation’:** Ibid., p. 543.

187 **All applications and documents presented to the court:** Schimmel, *The Empire of the Great Mughals*, p. 73.

187 **‘The farman is folded so that both corners touch, then a paper knot is tied’:** Ibid.

187 **‘A tremendous battle took place’: Badauni,** *Muntakhabh al-Tawarikh, Vol. 2, p. 136.*

188 **lashing out at Gujar Khan Afghan with a whip:** Khan, *The Political Biography of a Mughal Noble*, p. 143.

188 **‘incorporating’ Daud Khan into the body of the emperor:** Richard M. Eaton, *The Rise of Islam and the Bengal Frontier, 1204–1760*, Berkeley: University of California Press, 1993, p. 166.

188 **seizing the capital and possessing the land were two different matters:** Ibid., p. 142.

189 **‘the method to restrain the faction’:** Eaton, *India in the Persianate Age*, p. 230.